SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Course Descriptions

Contract All Courses |

Psychology

PY 2010 - Introduction to Psychology

Credits: 4

This course is a prerequisite to most of the psychology courses within the major. This course investigates basic psychological principles of behavior based on the scientific method. The sociocultural context in which humans develop is emphasized throughout. Areas of psychology to be covered include biological, cognitive, social, personality, clinical, diversity and social justice.

Prerequisite/Corequisite

EC I

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 2530 - Psychology of Prejudice & Discrimination

Credits: 4

This course explores the causes and consequences of prejudice and discrimination as social and psychological processes on individuals, groups and communities. The effects of prejudice, stereotypes, and discrimination and how they contribute to structural inequalities are investigated. Emphasis will be placed on the role of intersectional social group identities on one's understanding and experiences of prejudice and discrimination, and an examination of social action principles that address these dynamics.

Prerequisite/Corequisite

EC I

When Offered:

Every semester.

PY 2720 - Psychology of Gender

Credits: 4

This course examines the psychological, biological, and sociocultural correlates of gender. Theories of gender development, construction of gender identity, sexual orientation, and intersectionality of gender with other social group identities will be explored. Emphasis will be placed on the social constructs of traditional “masculine” and “feminine” gender roles throughout the lifespan with a consideration of relationships, education and career paths.

Prerequisite/Corequisite

EC I

PY 3010 - Research Design and Analysis I

Credits: 4

Introduces the student to the basic research methodologies and statistical techniques used by psychological scientists, with a focus on descriptive and correlational methods. Emphasis is placed on the process of scientific inquiry in general, and the concepts and terminology of psychological research in particular. Through a combination of lecture and laboratory exercises, students will learn to locate, read, and critique articles from the professional literature in psychology; understand the essential elements and principles of research design, including ethical considerations; conduct basic statistical analyses; interpret and graphically represent quantitative information; and write a literature review and/or empirical research report in the style recommended by the American Psychological Association.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of “C”); MA 1020 or MA 2000 (with a minimum grade of “C”); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 3020 - Health Psychology

Credits: 4

A broad, comprehensive review of theories, research, and psychological interventions applied to health, athletics and sports. Biological, psychological and social factors involved in health and well-being, health issues, and sports dynamics will be discussed, along with a more pragmatic understanding of the connection between health/athletic performance, and psychological processes and behavior. The impact of socioeconomic status, race and ethnicity, and gender will also be considered. Specific topics to be addressed include: stress and coping, athletic performance, and major health concerns such as heart disease, cancers, obesity, head trauma and traumatic brain injuries.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 3215 - Foundations of Child Development

Credits: 4

This course focuses on child development (ages 0-12). Major theories and research evidence will be presented relating to three areas of children's growth and development: (1) physical, including sensory-motor and brain development; (2) cognitive, including language, information processing and memory, problem solving, and metacognition; and (3) emotional and psychosocial, including self-identity, self-concept, and social functioning. Factors affecting children's development, including socioeconomic status, racial and multicultural backgrounds, gender and other diversity will be discussed throughout the course, along with additional societal influences, such as family, peer, schools and teachers, and the media. Lectures, videos and discussions, class exercises, and assigned projects are intended to enhance understanding of healthy growth and relevant issues and threats to children's development.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 3230 - Adulthood & Aging

Credits: 4

This course explores psychological development in the social context from early adulthood to old age. Personality theories and research methods as they apply to the study of aging are reviewed. Life cycle changes in family and work structure and roles are discussed. Additional topics include demographics, coping and successful aging, health, friendship and community, and death and dying. The impact of gender, culture and race and socioeconomic background are examined throughout. The course includes in-class exercises and a senior interview project.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 3240 - Lifespan Development

Credits: 4

This course will examine major theories and findings on human development, including stages of the lifespan that range from prenatal development through advanced old age. Each stage of the lifespan will be discussed within the context of physical, cognitive, and social/emotional development. Topics will also include research in developmental psychology, genetic foundations of development, as well as end of life issues.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Summers only

PY 3310 - Intro to Psychopathology

Credits: 4

Explores mental health challenges. In addition to surveying clinical-diagnostic systems, the course examines diverse experiences of mental distress as well as various explanatory models (e.g., biological, psychological, social, and cultural). Special attention is given to emerging areas of clinical research.

This course was formerly titled *Abnormal Psychology* and *Foundations of Clinical Psychology*.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

PY 3311 - Theories of Personality

Credits: 4

A survey of the major theories of personality and personality development, including psychoanalytic, behaviorist, cognitive, existential, and sociocultural theories.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every year

PY 3330 - Psychology of Addictions

Credits: 4

This course will review the current theories of addictions and the various treatment approaches available. Many controversies exist in the field not only as to what causes addictions but also as to how they should be treated and how society should respond. Students will be required to do research to back up their answers to weekly questions. Part of the course focus will be on how to critically evaluate research, websites, and periodicals, in addition to students' own beliefs. The course will consider chemical (e.g., alcohol and opioids), as well as behavioral (e.g., gambling and internet) addictions.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 3410 - Cognitive Psychology

Credits: 4

Theoretical, conceptual and empirical issues in cognition will be examined from an information processing perspective. The course also includes a survey of neurophysiological aspects of perception, memory and cognitive processes.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

PY 3420 - Learning and Motivation

Credits: 4

Explores major theoretical and empirical issues in the area of learning, classical and operant conditioning, and examines the role of motivation and emotion in learning. The course also surveys physiological, psychoanalytic and social learning theories of motivation and emotion.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Once a year

PY 3430 - Decision-Making and Judgment

Credits: 4

This course examines how people make decisions and judgments and how these decisions and judgments affect one's personal life and society. Topics include, but are not limited to, biases in ones' search for evidence, anchoring and adjustment, group think, framing and heuristics.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 3500 - Psychology Professional Development Seminar

Credits: 2

This seminar will provide an opportunity for students to understand the professional applications of their psychology degree. Students will explore and enhance skills developed over the course of their psychology degree, and learn how to translate and market those skills for their next professional step. Topics that will be explored include, but not limited to, career paths, graduate school, personal and professional identity and development, ethics, and cultural competence and awareness.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); 20 credits in Psychology; EMS

When Offered:

Every semester.

PY 3510 - Social Psychology

Credits: 4

This course is an introduction to the field of social psychology, which focuses on how we think and behave in social settings, and how our environment influences our behavior. Topics include attitude formation and change, social influence, persuasion, conformity and norms, group dynamics and group pressure, prosocial behavior, aggression, and prejudice and discrimination.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 3550 - Forensic Psychology

Credits: 4

Covers forms of industrial management, work satisfaction, theories of motivation and leadership, and issues of human resource management. Includes examining the organization of work in the US and globally and structural inequalities in access to workforce preparation, education, reward and human needs benefits. Topics such as: child labor; labor-management relationships; national and regional; national and international labor law as it applies to worker rights and protections; and the delivery of mental and medical health services will be covered.

Prerequisites

PY 2010

(with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010

(with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

PY 3565 - Organizational Psychology

Credits: 4

Organizational psychology is the scientific examination of how human cognition, attitudes, and behavior are influenced by the context of leaders, co-workers, and organizational policies, structure, and culture. This course helps students understand how successful organizations create optimal workplace environments. Topics may include selection, performance management, motivation, work attitudes, workplace satisfaction, leadership, and organizational behavior. Emphasis is placed on critical approaches to organizational psychology, including a consideration of inequalities in access to workforce preparation, education, reward and human needs benefits.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS; PY 3510 or PY 3570 Recommended

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 3570 - Community Psychology

Credits: 4

This course focuses on the application of community psychology action principles and research practices to the development and provision of resources and services necessary to well-functioning communities. Discussions cover prevention and intervention programs, empowerment, advocacy, and the impact of structural inequalities, political and social organization, and social group identity on community well-being. Special emphasis is placed on the application of concepts to social issues.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Once a year

PY 3610 - Brain & Behavior

Credits: 4

The course examines how the brain's mental processes regulate physiological changes in neurons thereby altering the expression of behaviors. Examples are drawn from both animal and human studies to establish structure-function relationships. Topics covered include: the structure and function of nerve cells, brain anatomy, psychopharmacology, and the genetics and evolution of behavior. Complex behaviors examined include: vision, audition, olfaction, gustation, somatosensation, vestibulation, sleep, learning, memory, cognition speech, and emotional/affective behaviors.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 3620 - Drugs and Behavior

Credits: 4

This course examines the relationships between brain structures, neurochemistry and psychiatric illness. The role of the brain in normal and pathological function will be studied with an emphasis on the use of psychoactive medications in the treatment of psychiatric disorders. Students will learn basic principles of pharmacology, including understanding

the dose response curve, the therapeutic index, routes and schedules of administration, site of action, main effects, side effects, and drug interactions. Issues of tolerence, dependence and the integration of medication treatment with psychotherapy will also be discussed.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Other

PY 3710 - Psychology and Social Justice

Credits: 4

This course will introduce the concept and theoretical basis of social justice and explore the experiences and psychological impacts of inequality, oppression, and privilege. Emphasis will be placed on investigating the structural dynamics behind the maintenance of oppressive institutions and systems, understanding the role of psychology in social issues, and applying social action principles to social problems and social movements. In addition to an intellectual understanding of social justice, this course will provide a framework for utilizing a social justice perspective in subsequent courses and in life actions.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 3720 - Feminist Psychology

Credits: 4

This course examines historical gender biases in psychology and society, the past and present contributions of women in the field, and the epistemologies and studies that laid the foundation for feminist psychology. Readings explore the social construction of gender and its intersections with race/ethnicity and socioeconomic status. Examines the impact of gender inequality on the workplace, relationships, family life, health, wellbeing, and civic participation. Analyzes the contributions and critiques of feminist movements and ideologies.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 3760 - Psychology of Socioeconomic Inequality

Credits: 4

This course investigates the causes and psychosocial consequences of economic inequality with a focus on the United States. Readings and discussions explore the beliefs, ideologies, attitudes, and behaviors that legitimize and challenge economic inequality and the impact of economic exclusion on individual and community wellbeing. The roles of classism, racism, sexism, and other systems of oppression will be considered in producing and maintaining resource disparities and the public policies and programs that work to promote economic justice. These issues will be understood using an intersectional framework.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS

When Offered:

Every other year.

PY 4010 - History of Psychology

Credits: 4

This course explores key historical and social events that shaped the field of psychology; the history of ideas such as "the mind"; when and how psychology became a science; life histories of psychologists; and how ideas about what is "normal" shape and are shaped by psychology. The course considers the major problems, ideas, and schools of thought which form the basis of modern psychological theories and methods. Ideas of structuralism, idealism, functionalism, psychoanalysis, behaviorism, will be discussed as they relate to the development of psychological theory. Original sources will be read and discussed.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS; and one of the following: PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620 or PY 3215 or PY 3230 or PY 3240 or PY 3310 or PY 3311 or PY 3510 or PY 3570 or PY 2530 or PY 2720 or PY 3710

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4130 - Field Experience and Research

Credits: 4

Students engage in supervised experience and field work in a wide variety of clinical, psychiatric/ psychological, community organizational and agency settings in mental and physical health, community action and civic engagement and social welfare settings. A weekly seminar will include student presentation of placement experiences and issues relevant to successful field work and service delivery. The impact of systematic structural inequalities, prejudice and discrimination, diversity and multicultural sensitivity are integrated into issues relevant to the availability and success of community mental health professionals and community resources. Field research techniques including observational methods and field notes will be covered in preparation for a final research paper integrating the internship experience with literature review. Students are required to engage in an approved placement 80 hours (distributed over at least ten weeks).

Students must complete a mandatory Field Orientation Workshop with the Field Director and secure an internship prior to registration. The Field Director will register students into Field after they meet the criteria for registration.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS; 24 credits in psychology; Permission from Field Director is Required

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 4200 - Research Design and Analysis II

Credits: 4

This is the second course of the integrated Research Methods sequence. This aim of this course is to train students in the methods, design, and implementation of research in Psychology. Students will critically review primary source

literature, generate testable hypotheses, collect and analyze data using appropriate statistical techniques in SPSS. Emphasis is placed on drawing evidence-based conclusions and the ability to communicate, in oral presentation and in written form using APA style. Assignments for this course include a literature review, data collection, statistical analysis and a complete APA-style empirical research report.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS; and MA 1020 or MA 2000 (with a minimum grade of "C")

When Offered:

Every semester

PY 4210 - The Exceptional Child

Credits: 4

This course presents a comprehensive introduction to psychopathology during childhood and adoles- cence. Major theories and empirical findings guide discussions of the various childhood and adolescent disorders, and intervention efforts aimed at ameliorating them. Children and teens and their behavior are viewed within the context of developmental processes, biopsychosocial factors, and norms. Neurodevelopmental disorders including Autism Spectrum Disorders, Intellectual Disability, Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder, as well as Learning Disabilities and Communication Disorders will be explored. Additional disorders such as Anxiety Disorders, Schizophrenia Spectrum/ Other Psychotic Disorders, Mood Disorders, Feeding and Eating Disorders, and Disruptive, Impulse-Control, and Conduct Disorders will be emphasized with the diagnostic relevance related to child/adolescent onset. The perspectives of parents and the role of schools in the process of assessing and providing interventions for children and adolescents are examined.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); EMS; and PY 3310 or PY 321 or PY 3240 or PY 2400

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4230 - Psychopathology of Aging

Credits: 4

This course focuses on the physical, cognitive, and biological changes that occur as a process of aging in adulthood and their impact on functional ability and disability. The changing needs of the individual as a function of these physiological and cognitive changes are examined from a global and cross-cultural perspective. The impact of these changes and their interaction with factors such as gender and socio-economic class are compared in developed and developing nations.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; PY 3215 or PY 3230 or PY 3240; EMS; PY 3610 highly recommended

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4240 - Applied Developmental Psychology

Credits: 4

This course introduces students to the field of human development by examining the application of knowledge and various theoretical frameworks with the aim of understanding and promoting optimal development. Additionally, in this course we will aim to theoretically and empirically highlight that physical, psychosocial, cognitive and emotional functions develop in historical, social, cultural, and spatial contexts. We survey classical psychological paradigms and examine research in applied settings, approaches to developmental assessment, and contemporary social issues which bear direct relevance on development of children and adolescents, as well as adults in the 21st century. We examine how developmental research can inform educational practices, parenting decisions, public policy, clinical practices, and help design interventions for improving youths' and adults' welfare.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3215 or PY 3230 or PY 3240; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4320 - Counseling Psychology

Credits: 4

This course is intended to be a survey of the nature of the counseling process. Screening, intake procedure, diagnosis, treatment models, treatment planning, and termination of treatment will be considered. The student who takes this course can be expected to gain the skills necessary for entry-level agency interviewing positions.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3310 or PY 3311; EMS

When Offered:

Fall semester.

PY 4330 - Behavior Modification

Credits: 4

This course will consist of in-depth discussion of concepts and principles of behavior change, and their application in various settings (such as clinical, home, school, and work settings). Cognitive-behavioral methods will also be discussed. Special emphasis will be placed on behavior change procedures, with numerous illustrations and some opportunities for students to practice the principles.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3310 or PY 3311 or PY 3420 or PY 3215 or PY 3240; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year.

PY 4340 - Psychological and Educational Evaluation

Credits: 4

This course examines the major approaches to psychological and psychoeducational testing, including assessment of intelligence, cognitive and intellectual functioning, school achievement, career and vocational interests, and personality. Test construction, reliability, validity, and use of testing for selection purposes are discussed. Additional topics covered include appropriate uses of testing, test bias and potential abuses of testing, and other sociocultural issues relevant to testing.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3310 or PY 3311 or PY 3215 or PY 3230 or PY 3240; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4350 - Peace, Violence & Conflict Resolution

Credits: 4

This course explores the role of psychology in efforts to promote peace and conflict resolution in the United States and internationally. The ideological structures that support war and serve as barriers to efforts to establish peace will be investigated. The efforts of local, regional, national and international organizations to promote peace, and the impact of protest movements will be central to the course.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 2530 or PY 2720 or PY 3710 or PY 3510 or PY 3570; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4401 - Developmental Neuropathology

Credits: 4

This course is a seminar that defines, compares, and contrasts a variety of neurodegenerative disorders (NDDs) within a cognitive neuroscience/neuropsychology framework. Some disorders are congenital (people are born with them), and some are acquired through unfortunate life situations such as sports injuries, concussions or other brain trauma or pathological age-related changes. Some examples of topics to be discussed are: Congenital Birth Defects, Childhood Disintegrative Disorders, Childhood Brain Trauma; developmental disorders such as autism, attention deficits and hyperactivity and specific learning disabilities, traumatic brain Injuries, Alzheimer's Disease, and other dementias. Evaluation, diagnosis, interventions as well as associated ethical issues will be discussed. This course will prepare students with a foundation for applied learning within rehabilitative and behavioral treatment settings, hospitals, clinics

and research facilities focused on NDD therapies.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year.

PY 4402 - Neuropsychopharmacology

Credits: 4

An in-depth examination of how psychological disorders alter the production, signaling and clearing of neurotransmitters in the brain and how well regulated drug treatment (i.e. anti-anxiety, anti-depressants, anti-psychotics, mood -stabilizers and anticonvulsants) can reduce symptoms, increase quality of life and 'rewire' brain networks improving psychological health. Topics include Bipolar Disorders, Depression, Anxiety, Schizophrenia, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder, and senescence (Aging). Basic and advanced concepts regarding how the frontal lobes govern behaviors in both normal and abnormal psychological functioning will be evaluated to better understand brain neurotransmission. The controversial nature of placebo effects, prescription drugs, recreational drugs of abuse and holistic approaches will be discussed.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; EMS

When Offered:

Once a year.

PY 4403 - Cognitive Neuroscience

Credits: 4

Cognitive neuroscience is the study of the neurological basis of psychological processes. The purpose of this course is to understand how the mind works by examining research in the areas of psychology, neurology, and neuroscience. The

course investigates the neural correlates of cognitive functions in attention, perception, language, memory, decision-making, skill learning, and consciousness. Investigation of the advances in knowledge made in the area is revealed through the examination of studies with neurological patients, in neuroimaging, and, when appropriate, studies conducted with animals. This burgeoning area is an interdisciplinary field and as such, we will examine studies not only from psychology, but also in neurology and neuroscience, and examine topics that have not traditionally been considered to be a part of cognitive psychology, such as emotions and social processing.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4420 - Adolescent Development

Credits: 4

This course will examine research theory about biological, cognitive, psychological and moral development and how parents, peers, schools, and the media influence development from early to late adolescence. Diversity including gender, multicultural, racial and socio-economic backgrounds will be a focus throughout. Major behavioral problems during adolescence and current social and educational issues will be discussed. Class lectures and discussions and collaborative learning groups will be based on the text and original articles. Exams and assignments will involve writing, critical analysis and a field or library research project.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3215 or PY 3240; EMS

When Offered:

Every year

PY 4530 - Prevention, Promotion, Program Evaluation

Credits: 4

This course examines the role of psychological research and practice in developing, applying, and assessing interventions designed to prevent social problems and promote wellbeing. Emphasis is placed upon social and cultural relevance of interventions; the role of social structures; considering the interests, needs and inclusion of various stakeholder groups; and empowering individuals and communities to increase access, self-determination, and sustain positive change. The course also examines the process for determining the effectiveness and efficiency of programs and continuous program improvement.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3510 or PY 3570; EMS

When Offered:

Every other semester

PY 4570 - Peer Support & Community Mental Health

Credits: 4

This course examines the role of individual and group peer support in formal and informal contexts, with a special focus on community mental health. Emphasis will be placed on contemporary theory and research, the attractiveness and effectiveness of support groups and the experience of providing and receiving peer support. Topics to be discussed include, but are not limited to, addiction, cancer and other illnesses, eating disorders, bereavement, mental illness, and parenting. An examination of community mental health, which addresses the broader social contexts in which mental health challenges occur, will include considerations of how belonging, relationships and citizenship contribute to individual and group well-being.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3310 or PY 3510 or PY 3570; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4610 - Clinical Neuropsychology

Credits: 4

This course is an in-depth review of the neuropsychological bases of clinical pathologies including the major forms of dementia, affective disorders, schizophrenia and some childhood disorders such as autism. Etiology, neuropsychological assessment, mechanisms of drug action, as well as the neuropsychological bases of other forms of intervention are discussed. Requirements include exams and a research paper.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4730 - Psychology of Peoples of African Descent

Credits: 4

This course investigates the social, cultural, political and historical factors that shape the psychological development and functioning of African descent peoples (Afro-Latino, Afro-Caribbean, African American and African people who were born on the continent of Africa) in the United States. As we study the multiple challenges African descent peoples face, we are mindful to attend to their strength, resilience, adaptability, and healthy functioning. We study how the multiple contexts in which African descent people function and the various institutions with which they interact have influenced their growth, patterns of interaction, socio-economic status, and self-determination. The effect of structural oppression on African descent peoples is a major area of focus. We critically analyze research on and media representations of African descent individuals.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 2530 or PY 2720 or PY 3710 or PY 3510 or PY 3570; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4740 - Psychology of Ethnicity

Credits: 4

This course explores the multifaceted dimensions of the ways people identify themselves and are identified by others in this country based on their physical appearance, nationality, language and culture. Recognizing that "race" is socially constructed, not a scientific concept, the varied impacts of both race and ethnicity on individual, familial and community development will be explored. The course will delve into the experiences of various racial/ethnic groups, acknowledging that the experiences of an individual labeled "Latinx" can vary tremendously based on how they are identified "racially." The focus of the course will rotate among: Native American/Indigenous, Asian American, African American/Black, white/European American, and Latinx populations.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 2530 or PY 2720 or PY 3710; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 4760 - Sexual Identities & LGBTQ+ Psychology

Credits: 4

This course will consider the experience of lesbian, gay, bisexual, and transgender individuals from a psychological perspective. Students will learn theories and research on compulsive heterosexuality, heterosexism and homophobia. Additionally, topics such as culture and sexual and gender-identity and gender expression diversity, issues of history and community of LGBTQ+ individuals, and perspectives on sex, gender, and sexuality from queer theory will be discussed. The impact of public and policy in medical, military, and other contexts will be explored, especially the struggle to end "conversion therapies." Intersectionality, feminist theory, and the study of structural oppression will be foundational issues in this course.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 2530 or PY 2720 or PY 3710 or PY 3510 or PY 3215 or PY 3240 or PY 3720; EMS

When Offered:

Every other year

PY 5210 - Senior Seminar in Developmental Psychology

Credits: 4

This course provides an in-depth evaluation of theory and research about specific periods in the human lifespan, such as childhood, adolescence, and young, middle and late adulthood. A major theme of the course will be research strategies and designs used to study human development. Course topics and projects will examine biological, cognitive, psychological and/or socioemotional functioning across the lifespan, along with biopsychosocial factors that may influence such functioning, including socioeconomic factors, gender, and ethnic, racial/ multiracial, and cultural background.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3215 or PY 3230 or PY 3240 or PY 2400; EMS

When Offered:

Once a year

PY 5320 - Senior Seminar: Advanced Issues in Clinical Psychology

Credits: 4

In-depth examination and critical analysis of selected, current topics in clinical psychology. Topics include: approaches to psychotherapy, global mental health, psychology of violence, trauma and resilience, and special clinical topics.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3310 or PY 3311 or PY 4210; EMS

When Offered:

Once a year

PY 5404 - Senior Seminar in Environmental Neuroplasticity

Credits: 4

Twenty percent (1 in 5 children) in the US live in poverty. Poverty exposes children to many physical and psychosocial stressors which directly affect brain development, maturation, and adaptation in response to the environment. These stressors are not limited to but include: lack of food security (resulting in malnutrition); substandard living conditions which pose health risks (noise and air pollution, overcrowding and poor sanitation) in unsafe neighborhoods, and exposure to environmental toxins like lead and asbestos. Low income children, both rural and urban, are at increased

risk for experiencing psychological stressors such as: family turmoil, early childhood separation, physical and psychological abuse and trauma when compared to children from middle-income backgrounds. Very similar factors also impact the lives of new immigrant children and adults. Over time and in combination, these psychological, psychosocial and environmental stressors have significant effects on brain development and brain function. This senior seminar will systematically examine these poverty-related stressors and their effects on neurobiology. It will also examine factors that ameliorate these stressors and their neurobiological consequences. Students will be required to read, analyze, and discuss primary resources both orally and in writing, and produce a APA-style literature review thesis paper.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; EMS

When Offered:

Summers on demand

PY 5510 - Senior Seminar in Social Psychology

Credits: 4

This course focuses on areas of theory and research of current concern to social psychologists. Content that may be covered in this course includes: psychological aspects of public policies and programs; power, oppression and liberation; impact of resource disparities; environmental and economic sustainability; stigma and stereotypes; impact of media on social behavior; social conflict and group functioning; social inclusion and exclusion; empowering settings; impact of social structure on psychological functioning; or the impact of community-based research methods on social issues.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3510 or PY 3570; EMS

When Offered:

Once a year

PY 5610 - Senior Seminar in Neuroscience

Credits: 4

This course explores current research into the biological substrates of normal cognitive functions such as: memory, learning, attention and language. It also covers pathological states such as depression, schizophrenia, traumatic brain injuries, and dementia. Other topics of review and discussion include the neuropharmacology of psychoactive drugs, neuropsychological assessment and evaluation techniques and other forms of rehabilitation and intervention.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3410 or PY 3420 or PY 3610 or PY 3620; EMS

When Offered:

Once year

PY 5710 - Senior Seminar in Diversity & Social Justice

Credits: 4

This course examines current issues, debates, and psychological scholarship on special topics related to social justice and diversity. Content that may be covered includes: power dynamics, interpersonal and structural inequities, movements for social change, intersectionality, cultural competence and humility, and others. Students will read selected texts, complete a major paper or project on a selected topic, and engage in in-depth discussions to explore multiple intersecting dimensions of identity, positionality, and privilege.

Prerequisites

PY 2010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 3010 (with a minimum grade of "C"); PY 2530 or PY 2720 or PY 3710; EMS

When Offered:

Once a year

PY 9000 - Teaching Assistant/Peer Tutor

Credits: 2-8

The TA program provides a peer support system for students enrolled in the research methodology courses. TAs provide one-on-one tutorial assistance with the conceptual and writing skills relevant to the research sequence. TAs actively participate in course-related activities such as library research, assisting with in-class activities, and preparing mini-lectures to present in class. Tutorial and meeting hours are arranged by the instructor. Credits offered range from a

minimum of 2 to a maximum of 8, and are dependent on instructional need.

Prerequisites

Recommendation of Instructor

Contract All Courses |